the 47 nations gathering of heads of states and governments.

After attending the N-Security Summit, Dr. Singh left for Brazil to participate in the IV BRIC (Brazil-Russia-India-China) Summit. On the sidelines, Dr. Singh held talks with Chinese President Hu Jintao on several bilateral issues, particularly trade and investment. The Chinese President looked forward to Indian President Pratibha Patil's visit to China. The Indian President Pratibha Devisingh Patil visited China in May 2010.

Following his BRIC Summit, Dr. Singh also went to attend the IBSA (India-Brazil-South Africa) Summit where Iran's controversial nuclear programme and the impending UN sanctions were the 'focused agenda'.

On Prime Minister Manmohan Singh's visit to Hanoi during the ASEAN Summit, he expressed high hopes regarding the completion of all formalities of India-ASEAN Trade in Goods Agreement signed in Bangkok in August 2009 after six years of negotiations and coming into force from 1 January 2010. He also announced extension of visa-on-arrival facility to travellers from Cambodia, Vietnam and Philippines as part of the overall package for the initiative for ASEAN integration. He pushed for ASEAN unity and emphasized that the ASEAN is the "core around which the process of economic integration of the Asia-Pacific region should be built."

On the whole, the year 2010 has been quite an eventful year for India, with a number of visits by important dignitaries from important countries and consequential diplomatic parleys. What is most remarkable is that in one year there were visits from P-5 members countries in 2010. India has also been elected as a non-permanent member of the United Nations Security Council with an overwhelming number of countries endorsing its sole candidature from the Asian group. In polling for 10 seats that took place at the UN headquarters in New York on 10 October, 2010, India received the highest number of votes—187 out of 192—among all countries in the fray. However, given the background of power equations, one cannot be jubilant over the Security Council membership until and unless a permanent seat is not secured by India.

There has been certain setbacks in Indo-Pakistan relations, but